Karen Dettmar

UX Engineer · Design Technologist · New York City
karen.dettmar@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kdettmar · karendettmar.com

SKILLS & TOOLS

Engineering	JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS, Node.js, REST APIs, SDK integration, responsive UI, WCAG accessibility, Git, TypeScript, Vue, Astro, Tailwind CSS
Design	Figma, prototyping in code, wireframing, user flows, usability testing

EXPERIENCE

Developer Advocate · Intuit New York, NY — Nov 2022 – Sept 2024

Design and front-end engineering for internal developer platforms

- Designed and built a **React** scorecard, leaderboard, and reporting interface for the scaled InnerSource Tournament, replacing the pilot's spreadsheet scoring, with a platform engineer setting up a weekly pull of each service's maturity data from the developer portal. **Result: 150 participants, and 40% of the services scored became ready for other teams to adopt on their own.**
- Built and shipped engineer-facing tools and interactive learning experiences used by **7,000+ global employees**, owning the full development lifecycle from prototype through public deployment.
- Delivered internal training on React Security, InnerSource, OpenSource, **Design Systems,** and documentation standards, including the design systems session in new-employee onboarding.
- Wrote a conference talk on **accessibility, WCAG and ADA compliance**, accepted at **All Things Open**.
- Partnered with a staff engineer and product manager to roll out **GitHub Copilot** access to Intuit's engineering organization at a company-wide virtual AI event, building the announcement deck and a live demo of installing and using it; interviewed the AI and Data teams on the tools they had built and hosted fireside chats on the future of AI in software development.

Developer Advocate · Wix New York, NY — Feb 2020 – Oct 2022

Product design, user research and front-end for the developer platform

- Built the demo product for the first ever **Wix DevCon** from scratch, on several platform services that had not yet shipped, carrying it through prototyping, QA, and approvals with PMs, engineers, marketing, and the CEO against a fixed launch date it had to work on live. **Result:** the build surfaced and fixed platform bugs, and I presented it in the keynote to a 300-person live audience.
- Taught workshops on JavaScript fundamentals, UI/UX best practice, and design-to-code transitions, including a workshop that took college design students through their portfolio finals.
- Designed and ran a user study assessing developer experience on the platform. **Findings drove product, R&D, and UX to ship onboarding UI updates, refreshed documentation, and new product features.**
- Asked for a new-hire onboarding deck, built an **onboarding site** on the Wix platform instead and revised it from new-hire feedback. **Result: time on the homepage doubled.**

Front End Developer · Wet Design Burbank, CA — Feb 2019 – Jul 2019

- Designed and built the front end of an internal **travel request and approval app** that replaced a legacy system: interviewed the travel manager and frequent travelers, designed the workflow, wireframes and UI, and coded a **responsive single-page app** in VueJS, JavaScript, HTML, SASS, and GraphQL as the sole front-end developer. **Result: after IT testing and a departmental pilot, it rolled out company-wide.**
- Redesigned and deployed the company intranet, consulting with the branding team on interface and technical requirements to make it the primary channel for company communication. Built and **usability tested** its components in Confluence, CSS, and JavaScript. **Result: 25% increase in time on page.**
- Maintained, updated, and built **mobile modular components** for the existing site.

Head Designer, Print and Web · Pixomondo (PXO) Los Angeles, CA — Jan 2018 – Jan 2019

- Redesigned and implemented the company website, meeting regularly with the CEO on design direction. Built on a **LEMP stack (CentOS, NGINX, MySQL, PHP)** with a **WordPress theme written from scratch. Result: 10% increase in page visits**, and the redesign was what made the campaign launch on schedule.
- Built a **Raspberry Pi conference room booking system** for the studio.

Jr Front End Developer and Designer · CIBT Washington, D.C. — Jan 2017 – Nov 2017

- Built **clean, scalable, responsive templates** by hand in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, built to **WCAG** standards.
- Ran on-site polls on the visa requirements page and the application funnel to find out why travelers were leaving. When the first round returned thin answers, redesigned the survey to open with a yes/no question before the open one. **Result: one week of the redesigned survey drew more than double what five weeks of the original had**, and the coded responses ranked the blockers, led by unclear requirements.
- Maintained and redesigned components for multilingual company sites, providing bespoke landing pages for high-profile corporate clients (**Microsoft, Apple, IBM**) alongside the consumer-facing traveler experience.

EDUCATION

Certification in Fashion Design
Parsons School of Design – The New School · Full-time 2025

Full Stack Web Development Program: MEAN, Ruby on Rails, Python & Django
Coding Dojo · Washington, D.C.

B.A. Studio Art (Printmaking) · B.A. Politics (Foreign Affairs)
University of Virginia